Fund OS: product requirements for the technical overhaul of an early stage fund's tooling

Prepared for the PROfounders Capital conversation (Business Analyst & AI Automation). Author: Roland-Caryl Obam. Version 0.1, 4 October 2026. Status: draft for the discovery call. Audience: partners, the analyst who will own the system, and whoever signs off on data access.

Conventions. Requirements are tagged MUST, SHOULD or COULD. Every number is one of three kinds and is labelled as such: public (with its source), fund-provided (to be measured in week one of the pilot), or illustrative (my assumption, to be replaced by the fund's own figure). No price appears in this document; commercial terms are discussed on the call.

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0. Why this document exists

The role description asks for one thing in two halves: structure and track portfolio and financial data, and build the AI and automation system that runs the full pipeline from sourcing to screening to diligence to portfolio monitoring, with investor reporting and audits underneath. This PRD treats that as what it is: a technical overhaul of a fund's tooling, delivered as six modules on one platform, each with a measurable financial upside, a scoping method, a build plan, a production standard and an improvement loop.

It also exists to draw a line against a category of tool that is easy to build and dangerous to run. The reference demo shared alongside this document (an "AI VC agent" that reads a deck, chats about valuation, drafts a memo, interprets a financial model and emails a $200k term sheet to a founder, end to end, with no human step) shows every capability a fund would want and none of the properties a fund can live with: no ground truth, no evaluation, no audit trail, no integration with the system of record, an external action taken by a machine, and numbers it cannot explain. Fund OS is built from the opposite end: ground truth first, evaluation underneath, every external action held for a person.

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1. Context and problem statement

1.1 What the fund is, in its own words

Pan-European early stage fund, backing "the fixers": founders repairing broken customer experiences. Tickets of €500k to €3m, lead or syndicate. Companies with a working product and early validation, European HQ or significant presence, tech-enabled B2B or B2C. Twenty-six active portfolio companies in about ten countries, thirty-two exits, investing since 2009; the fund meets thousands of companies a year and invests in six to eight (source: profounderscapital.com, read 28 September 2026).

1.2 What the numbers say about where the work is

A survey of 885 VCs reports roughly a hundred opportunities considered per deal closed, with about one in four reaching a management meeting, one third of those a partner meeting, half of those due diligence, and 118 hours of due diligence on average per closed deal over about 83 days (Gompers, Gornall, Kaplan, Strebulaev, "How Do Venture Capitalists Make Decisions?", Journal of Financial Economics, 2020, NBER w22587; fractions rounded). Three quarters of the work of a fund is deciding what not to meet. Each of those decisions already carries a label in the fund's CRM.

1.3 The problems, as I expect to find them (to be confirmed in discovery)

- Deal flow lives in inboxes and a CRM that stores decisions but does not learn from them. First passes are inconsistent across people, days and fatigue.

- Portfolio data arrives as founder emails and board decks in different formats; the monthly picture is assembled by hand and is stale by the time it is read.
- Benchmarks across the portfolio are computed ad hoc; LP letters are written from scratch each quarter.
- Diligence memos repeat the same extraction work on every data room.
- Audits and LP information requests trigger a document hunt.
- Anything "AI" tried so far is a chat window with no measurement, so nobody knows whether it helps.

1.4 What "good" looks like in twelve months

One pipeline from inbox to decision with a consistent, explained first pass; one monthly portfolio schema with flags the day an update lands; benchmarks and the LP letter drafted from the same table; diligence memos that start at eighty percent; a document vault that makes an audit a query, not a hunt. And, under all of it, a weekly read-out that says how well the system agrees with partners, so that trust is earned by numbers.

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2. Goals, non-goals, success metrics

2.1 Goals

1. Reduce the cost and raise the consistency of the first pass on inbound deals, measured against the fund's own past decisions.
2. Turn portfolio monitoring from collection work into exception handling.
3. Produce LP-facing material (quarterly letter, benchmarks, data requests) from a single source of truth.
4. Make every automated decision auditable: logged, bounded, measured.
5. Leave the fund owning the system: code, data, keys, documentation.

2.2 Non-goals (for the first year)

- Replacing partner judgement on investment decisions. The system assists diligence and never decides.
- Automating any outbound communication to founders or LPs without a person sending it.
- Sourcing automation before screening is measured. Sourcing has no ground truth inside the fund.
- Valuation, term sheet generation or legal drafting. The reference demo does this; a fund should not.
- A new CRM. The system sits on top of the existing one.

2.3 Success metrics (north star per module, measured weekly)

Module	Metric	Bar (illustrative, set with a partner in week one)
M1 Screening	Recall on "took a meeting", precision on "meet", minutes per deal including human review	Recall 85 % or more; precision 60 % or more; 5 minutes or less
M2 Monitoring	Share of portfolio companies with complete monthly KPI set by day 10; time from update to flag	90 % or more; same day
M3 Benchmarks and LP letter	Hours from quarter end to letter draft; number of manual data pulls	Draft within 3 working days; zero manual pulls
M4 Diligence assist	Share of memo sections accepted without rewrite; citations verified	60 % or more; 100 % of figures traceable
M5 Sourcing signals	Share of flagged companies a partner marks "worth a look"	20 % or more, measured monthly
M6 Fund ops and audits	Time to answer an auditor or LP data request	Under one hour for standard requests

Module	Metric	Bar (illustrative, set with a partner in week one)
Platform	Automated external actions; silent failures; weekly read-out delivered	0; 0; every Friday

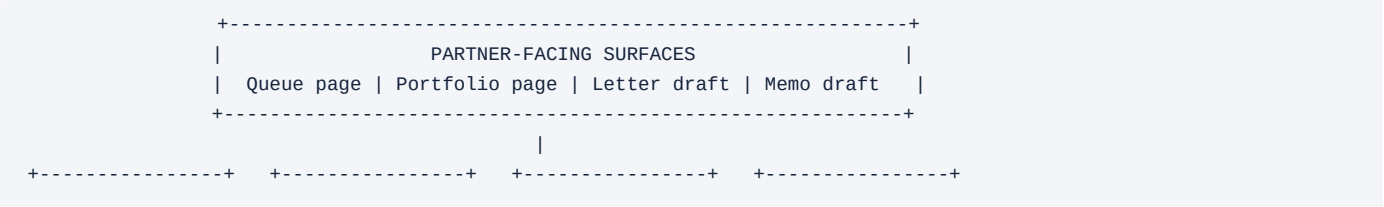
3. Users and jobs to be done

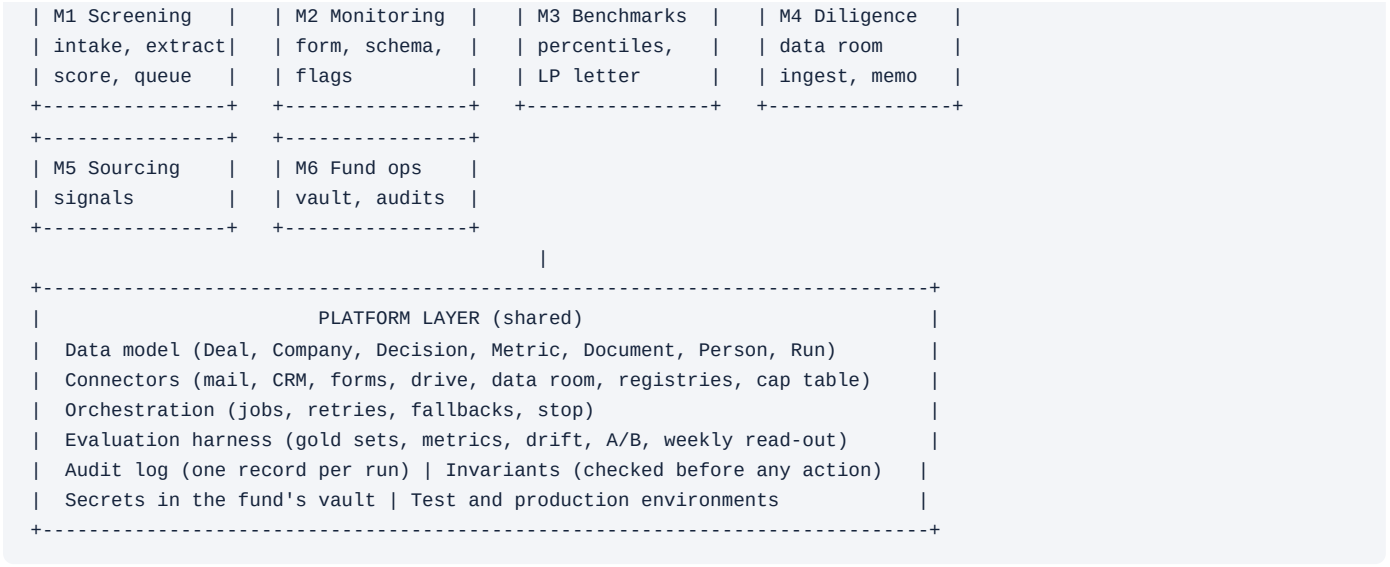
User	Jobs	What they need from the system
Partner	Decide what to meet; decide what to fund; answer LPs; sit on boards	A ranked queue with reasons attached; a monthly portfolio page with flags; a letter draft; nothing sent in their name without their click
Analyst or associate (the role being hired)	First pass; data chasing; memo drafting; reporting	A first pass done before coffee; a single schema; a memo that starts at 80 %; an audit log that defends every number
Founder	Report monthly without pain; get a decision on an intro	One short form, pre-filled where possible; a clear and timely answer written by a human
LP	Trust the numbers; get answers fast	Letters and data requests that reconcile to the same table every quarter
Auditor, fund administrator	Evidence	Documents and decisions retrievable by query, with provenance
Builder (me, then the fund)	Ship safely; measure; hand over	Test and production separated; evaluation harness; runbooks

4. Principles (non-negotiable design rules)

1. Automate where a decision already has a label; assist where it does not; never let the machine act outside the fund on its own.
2. Ground truth before models. No module ships before its gold set exists and its bar is signed.
3. Every automated output carries its inputs, its reasons and its cost, in one log record, queryable by a partner in one click.
4. Human-in-the-loop invariants are code, not policy: no message to a founder or an LP, no archive, no rejection, no criteria change without a named person.
5. Built inside the fund's stack (Google Workspace, the existing CRM, the existing data room), with accounts and API keys in the fund's name, revocable any day.
6. Models are replaceable components behind an interface; any change is an A/B on the gold set before it ships.
7. Data stays in the fund's tenant. Nothing is trained on the fund's data outside the fund's control.
8. Boring cadence: kickoff, Friday Loom, biweekly check-in, the fund's own test week, a definition of done written before the build.

5. Architecture overview





5.1 Data model (minimum)

- Deal: source, received_at, company_id, stage, status, owner, decision (meet, pass, keep warm), decision_by, decision_at, score, score_reasons, gaps, criteria_version.
- Company: legal name, HQ country, website, registry id, model (B2B, B2C), sector tags, founders, round sought, ticket fit.
- Decision: deal_id, person, outcome, timestamp, reason free text. This table is the training and test set for M1.
- Metric: company_id, period, kpi (growth, net burn, runway, gross margin, NRR, CAC payback, burn multiple), value, source, confidence, flag.
- Document: owner entity, type, version, hash, location, retention class, provenance.
- Run: module, inputs (hashes), model and prompt version, outputs, reason, cost, latency, status, invariant checks, reviewer.

5.2 Integration inventory (to confirm in discovery)

Mailbox (shared deal flow inbox), CRM (Affinity, HubSpot, Notion or Airtable, whichever is in place), Google Workspace (Drive, Sheets, Forms), data room (DocSend, Drive, Dropbox), cap table and fund admin (Carta or equivalent, read only), company registries (Companies House, INPI, Brønnøysund and peers via public APIs), calendar.

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6. Module requirements

Each module lists purpose, requirements, invariants, evaluation, data, financial upside with its formula, and rollout. Effort is given as a range in person-weeks for one builder; it is an estimate, not a commitment.

M1. Screening: from inbox to a partner decision

Purpose. Turn every inbound opportunity into one CRM record with a score against the fund's written thesis, the evidence found, the gaps, and a position in a ranked queue; the partner decides.

Requirements. - M1-F1 MUST ingest from the shared inbox, web form and CRM "new" status; dedupe by domain and founder email. - M1-F2 MUST extract a fixed schema from deck, website and registry (company, HQ, model, product status, traction, round, prior investors), each field with a source pointer and a confidence. - M1-F3 MUST score against versioned criteria derived from the published thesis (broken customer experience, working product, early validation, European HQ or significant presence, tech-enabled B2B or B2C, stage and ticket fit) with weights set with a partner in week one; the score MUST carry the reasons per criterion and the list of gaps. - M1-F4 MUST write one record per deal to the CRM with status "scored"; MUST NOT change any status beyond that. - M1-F5 MUST

present a ranked queue (web page or CRM view) with score, reasons, gaps and a one-click override that records the partner's decision and reason. - M1-F6 SHOULD draft the reply to the founder (meet, pass, keep warm) with the gap questions, saved as a draft in the mailbox, never sent. - M1-F7 SHOULD propose a "revisit trigger" for keep-warm deals (for example first 100 paying orders) and resurface the deal when a public signal matches. - M1-F8 COULD run shadow mode indefinitely for any criteria version not yet promoted.

Invariants (checked in code before any write). No outbound message; no archive or rejection; no change to criteria weights; no record deleted; no score without a logged reason.

Evaluation. Gold set: the last 200 inbound decisions with outcomes, extended monthly. Metrics: recall on "took a meeting", precision on "meet", minutes per deal including review, disagreement rate, drift versus previous week. Weekly read-out on Friday; alarm when recall drops more than 5 points.

Financial upside. Formula: (inbound per year × minutes manual first pass) minus (inbound per year × (machine minute + human review minutes)), valued at the analyst's loaded hourly cost; plus the unmeasured value of the deal nobody had time to open. Illustrative: 1,500 inbound × 20 min = 500 h; after: 1,500 × 4 min of review = 100 h; 400 h a year, about ten working weeks, at the fund's own hourly cost. Consistency is the second upside: the same thesis applied on a Friday night and a Monday morning. Both replaced by the fund's numbers in week one.

Effort. 4 to 6 person-weeks for the pilot, 2 to 3 more for production hardening.

M2. Portfolio monitoring: one form, one schema, flags the day the update lands

Purpose. Collect the same six KPIs from every portfolio company every month, normalise them, flag anomalies, and give partners one page.

Requirements. - M2-F1 MUST provide a founder update form (web form or email template parsed on receipt) with the KPI schema: ARR or MRR growth, net burn and runway, gross margin, NRR or cohort retention, CAC payback, burn multiple; each with period, currency, source and a free-text comment. - M2-F2 MUST parse board decks and update emails into the same schema when a founder does not use the form, with confidence and a source pointer per value; low-confidence values are queued for the analyst, not written as facts. - M2-F3 MUST compute derived metrics (runway from cash and net burn, burn multiple from net burn and net new ARR) and show the formula. - M2-F4 MUST raise flags against thresholds set per company and stage (illustrative: runway under 12 months; growth below plan two months running; gross margin falling two quarters; NRR under 100 %; CAC payback over 18 months; burn multiple over 2.0x) the same day the update lands. - M2-F5 MUST chase missing updates with a draft reminder saved for the analyst to send; never sent automatically. - M2-F6 SHOULD show per-company history and the portfolio page with percentiles (see M3). - M2-F7 COULD ingest bank statements or management accounts shared by the company for reconciliation.

Invariants. No message to a founder; no value written below the confidence bar without review; every value traceable to a source.

Evaluation. Completeness by day 10 of the month; parse accuracy on a labelled set of 50 past updates; time from update to flag; false flag rate reviewed monthly with a partner.

Financial upside. Formula: companies × monthly collection and normalisation time × 12, at the analyst's loaded hourly cost, plus the option value of early warning (one runway problem seen three months earlier is a bridge negotiated instead of a write-off; unmeasured, to be tracked as cases). Illustrative: 26 companies × 45 minutes × 12 = about 230 hours a year.

Effort. 3 to 5 person-weeks.

M3. Benchmarks and the LP letter from the same table

Purpose. Compute portfolio-level insight from M2 data and draft the quarterly letter and the LP data pack from it.

Requirements. - M3-F1 MUST compute percentiles across the portfolio per KPI, by stage and sector, each quarter, with the cohort definition visible. - M3-F2 MUST draft the quarterly LP letter sections that are data-driven (portfolio summary, company highlights, flags resolved) from the metric table, with every figure linked to its source row;

narrative sections are written by partners. - M3-F3 MUST produce the standard LP data request pack (schedule of investments, valuations as provided by the fund administrator, KPI summary) as an export reconciled to the same table. - M3-F4 SHOULD maintain a pattern register (for example: companies with NRR over 110 % at seed, time from first flag to resolution) that partners can query in plain language, answers citing rows. - M3-F5 COULD compare the portfolio to public benchmark sets, clearly labelled as external and with their source.

Invariants. No figure in a letter without a source row; no letter leaves the fund without a partner's edit and send; valuations are inputs from the administrator, never computed by the system.

Evaluation. Hours from quarter end to first draft; number of figures corrected by partners per letter (target trending to zero); reconciliation check passes 100 %.

Financial upside. Formula: (days per quarter spent assembling the letter and data pack today minus days after) × 4, at partner and analyst loaded cost; plus LP confidence, unmeasured but visible in fewer follow-up questions. Illustrative: 4 days to 1 day per quarter.

Effort. 3 to 4 person-weeks after M2.

M4. Diligence memo assist: the memo starts at eighty percent

Purpose. Ingest a data room and produce the factual sections of the investment memo with citations, a red-flag list and a question list, for the deal team to complete.

Requirements. - M4-F1 MUST ingest a data room (folder of PDFs, spreadsheets, decks) and build an index with document provenance. - M4-F2 MUST draft the factual sections of the fund's own memo template (company, product, market as described by the company, traction, team, round, cap table summary) with a citation per figure to the source document and page. - M4-F3 MUST produce a red-flag list (inconsistencies between documents, missing standard documents, metrics that do not reconcile) and a question list for management. - M4-F4 MUST mark anything not found in the data room as "not in data room" rather than filling from general knowledge. - M4-F5 SHOULD extract the financial model into the fund's standard sheet with a reconciliation check (totals, cash, burn) and highlight interpretation choices for a human to accept or reject. - M4-F6 COULD run a reference-check tracker (who, when, notes) owned by the deal lead.

Invariants. No investment recommendation; no valuation; no outbound request to the company or references; no figure without a citation.

Evaluation. Share of sections accepted without rewrite; citation accuracy on a sample checked by the deal lead; red flags later confirmed versus missed, reviewed per deal.

Financial upside. Formula: diligence hours per closed deal (public average 118 h, Gompers et al.) × share spent on extraction and first drafting (fund-provided) × deals per year. Illustrative: 20 % of 118 h on 7 deals is about 165 h a year, and faster memos mean faster answers to founders, which is a sourcing advantage.

Effort. 4 to 6 person-weeks.

M5. Sourcing signals: only after screening is measured

Purpose. Surface companies that match the thesis before they reach the inbox, from public signals, scored with the same criteria as M1, for a partner to decide whether to reach out.

Requirements. - M5-F1 MUST collect public signals for the fund's geographies (new company registrations in target categories, job postings indicating product traction, app store releases, open source activity for developer-facing products, press and accelerator cohorts) with the source stored. - M5-F2 MUST score candidates with M1's criteria and show the evidence; low-evidence candidates are not shown. - M5-F3 MUST hold any outreach as a draft in the partner's mailbox with a reason line; never sent automatically. - M5-F4 SHOULD learn from the partner's "worth a look" and "no" marks as a second gold set. - M5-F5 COULD track warm paths (shared investors, portfolio founders) to a candidate.

Invariants. No outreach; no scraping outside sources permitted by their terms; signals stored with their licence.

Evaluation. Share of flagged companies marked "worth a look"; share that reach a meeting; false positive rate per source, so that noisy sources are switched off.

Financial upside. Formula: partner sourcing hours per week (public survey figure: about 22 of 55 hours; Gompers et al.) × share redirected from scanning to conversations; the real upside is one deal seen first, unmeasured by design and tracked as cases.

Effort. 3 to 5 person-weeks, only after M1 has passed its bar for two consecutive months.

M6. Fund operations and audits: an audit becomes a query

Purpose. A document vault and a decision register that answer auditor, administrator and LP requests in minutes, with retention and provenance.

Requirements. - M6-F1 MUST maintain a vault of fund documents (LPA and side letters as provided, investment documents, board materials, valuations from the administrator, KPI tables, LP letters) with version, hash, owner and retention class. - M6-F2 MUST keep the decision register (every IC decision, every M1 override, every criteria change) with who, when and why. - M6-F3 MUST answer standard requests ("all documents for company X in 2026", "KPI history for the portfolio Q1 to Q3") as exports with a provenance sheet. - M6-F4 SHOULD run compliance checks the fund defines (for example: board materials received per company per quarter; KYC documents present per LP) and raise flags to the ops owner. - M6-F5 COULD prepare the annual audit pack as a checklist with links.

Invariants. No document deleted by the system; no document shared outside the tenant by the system; access by role; every access logged.

Evaluation. Time to answer standard requests; completeness checks; audit findings related to documentation trending to zero.

Financial upside. Formula: days per year on audit and LP request preparation (fund-provided) × loaded cost, plus lower audit fees if the auditor's hours fall (to confirm with the auditor), plus reduced key-person risk when knowledge is in a system rather than in one inbox.

Effort. 3 to 5 person-weeks, phased with M3.

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7. The evaluation and reliability layer (cross-cutting)

7.1 Gold sets

One per module, owned by the fund: M1 the last 200 inbound decisions; M2 fifty labelled past updates; M3 the last four letters with their source data; M4 two past data rooms with their final memos; M5 partner marks collected monthly; M6 last year's audit requests and answers. Extended monthly; stored in the fund's tenant.

7.2 Metrics and the Friday read-out

Every Friday the system produces one page per live module: bar, this week, last week, disagreements to review, incidents, cost. Precision and recall for M1 and M5; completeness and parse accuracy for M2; reconciliation and corrections for M3; acceptance and citation accuracy for M4; request latency for M6. A partner reviews disagreements in a twenty-minute slot; every override becomes a training example.

7.3 Invariants, enforced in code

No message to a founder or an LP; no deal rejected or archived without a person; no data leaving the tenant; no score or figure without a logged reason or source; no criteria or threshold change without a partner's sign-off; no model change without an A/B on the gold set.

7.4 Failure handling

Retries, then a fallback model, then a stop; never a silent skip. Minor failures routed to the builder, major ones to a partner within the hour. Test and production separated; nothing ships untested. Every run has one log record: inputs, model and prompt version, output, reason, cost, latency, invariant results, reviewer.

7.5 Drift and improvement loop

Weekly: metrics against bar; monthly: gold set extended, thresholds reviewed; quarterly: criteria version review with partners, model A/B if a candidate exists, roadmap of the next module. Any change is logged in the decision register (M6-F2).

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8. Data, security and compliance

- Tenant: all data, logs and gold sets live in the fund's Google Workspace, CRM and chosen database; the builder's access is through accounts created in the fund's name and revocable any day.
- Secrets: API keys in the fund's secret manager; never in code or documents; usage billed to the fund's accounts.
- Personal data: founders' and LPs' personal data processed under UK GDPR and GDPR with a documented purpose; retention classes per document type; a deletion procedure for passed deals after the period the fund sets.
- Regulated status: the fund is FCA authorised (reference on its website). The system takes no decision and sends no communication; it produces records. Records retention and access logging support, rather than complicate, the fund's obligations; confirm specifics with the fund's compliance officer in scoping.
- Model providers: approved list set by the fund; data processing terms reviewed; no training on fund data; option to route sensitive modules (M4, M6) to models hosted in the fund's cloud tenant.
- Access: role-based (partner, analyst, ops, builder, read-only auditor); every access logged.

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9. Scoping strategy (phase 0, two weeks)

Objective: leave scoping with a signed definition of done for M1, a baseline, data access, and a gold set.

1. Thirty-minute call with a partner: how a deal moves from inbox to partner meeting today; where the first pass happens; who decides; what the CRM records.
2. Data access: export of the last 200 inbound deals with outcomes; read access to the shared inbox and CRM; sample of founder updates and the last two LP letters.
3. Baseline measured, not estimated: minutes per deal on ten real first passes timed with the analyst; completeness of last month's portfolio KPIs; days spent on the last letter.
4. Criteria workshop (one hour, partner plus analyst): the published thesis turned into six criteria with evidence definitions and weights; thresholds for recall, precision and minutes per deal; the stop rule.
5. Definition of done written as verifiable bullets; out of scope listed; the fund's obligations (access, response time) listed.
6. Deployment model chosen: A, inside the fund's stack with the builder administering (recommended); B, fully managed by the builder, only acceptable for a demo; C, handover after any module.
7. Risk register started: data quality in the CRM, mailbox permissions, criteria disagreement between partners, provider terms.

Discovery questions I will ask: Does deal flow live in a CRM today, or in the inbox? Who makes the first pass and how long does it take? How many inbound opportunities a year? How are founder updates collected and where do they go? How is the LP letter assembled and by whom? When was the last audit and what did it cost in days? Which tools are already paid for? Who owns API keys today?

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10. Implementation, build and production plan

Phase	Weeks	Scope	Exit criterion
0 Scoping	1 to 2	Section 9	Definition of done signed; gold set exported; access granted
1 Pilot M1	3 to 6	Week 3: build intake, extraction, scoring; run on the 200. Week 4 to 5: shadow mode on live deals; partners decide as today; weekly review of disagreements. Week 6: read-out	Bar met: continue to hardening; bar missed: stop, fund keeps dataset, pipeline and report
2 Hardening M1	7 to 9	Invariants in code, audit log, Friday read-out automated, test and production environments, runbooks, UAT week by the fund	Production checklist complete; one month at bar
3 M2 then M3	10 to 17	Form, schema, parsing, flags; then percentiles and letter drafting on the next quarter end	M2 completeness bar met; first letter drafted from the table
4 M4	18 to 23	Data room ingestion and memo assist on the next live deal plus two past data rooms	Acceptance and citation bars met
5 M6 then M5	24 to 32	Vault and decision register; compliance checks; then sourcing signals once M1 has held its bar two months	Audit request latency bar met; M5 "worth a look" bar met
Continuous	Weekly	Friday Loom, biweekly check-in, monthly gold set extension, quarterly criteria review	Read-out delivered every week

Cadence: thirty-minute kickoff with acceptance criteria, access and risks; a six-minute Loom every Friday (delivered, blocked, decisions needed); a twenty-minute check-in every two weeks near a milestone; the fund's own test week before each module goes live; a definition of done signed at the end of each module.

Handover checklist per module: test and production copies; configuration and secrets inventory (names, not values); JSON backups and restore procedure; a six-minute walkthrough; a one-page architecture map; runbook for the three most likely failures; support terms written down. Nothing depends on the builder being present.

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11. Economics: what the fund can expect to measure

All figures below are illustrative until replaced by the fund's numbers in week one. The point of the table is the formula, not the number.

Lever	Formula	Illustrative value	When measured
Screening hours	inbound × (manual minutes minus reviewed-machine minutes)	400 h a year at 1,500 inbound	Pilot read-out, day 30
Screening consistency	disagreement rate between first passes, before and after	from unmeasured to a weekly number	Shadow mode, weeks 4 to 5
Missed deals	deals reaching a meeting that would have been passed by time pressure	tracked as cases	Monthly from M1 production
Monitoring hours	companies × monthly collection minutes × 12	230 h a year at 26 companies	After two monthly cycles
Early warning	months of advance notice on runway flags	tracked as cases	Per flag
LP letter	days per quarter before and after × 4	3 days a quarter saved	First quarter end after M3
Diligence	share of 118 h public average spent on extraction × deals per year	about 165 h a year	Per deal after M4

Lever	Formula	Illustrative value	When measured
Audit and requests	days of preparation per year, and auditor hours if shared	fund-provided	Next audit
Run costs	model and infrastructure usage on the fund's accounts	typically a small fraction of the hours saved; measured per run in the log	Every Friday

Two things the table does not capture, by design: the value of a decision made consistently, and the value of LP trust when every number reconciles. Both show up in behaviour before they show up in a spreadsheet.

12. Risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
CRM data too sparse to build the gold set	Week-one check; fall back to inbox export plus partner labelling session (two hours for 200 deals)
Partners disagree on criteria	Criteria workshop with named owner; disagreements recorded; shadow mode until agreement rate is acceptable
Founder updates in unparseable formats	Form first, parsing second; low-confidence values queued, never written as facts
Model provider terms or outages	Approved provider list; fallback model; stop rule; no single provider dependency
Scope creep from "can it also"	Change request process; version 2 list; definition of done per module
Key-person dependency on the builder	Handover checklist per module; runbooks; the fund's analyst pairs on every build
Over-trust in scores	Reasons and gaps always visible; weekly disagreement review; invariants prevent any action on a score alone
Compliance surprise	Compliance officer in the scoping loop; records retention and access logging designed in

13. Open questions for the discovery call

1. Where does deal flow live today, and who owns the first pass?
2. How many inbound opportunities per year, and how many reach a meeting?
3. Which CRM, which data room, which fund administrator?
4. How are founder updates collected today, and what share arrives on time?
5. How is the LP letter produced, and how long does it take?
6. What did the last audit cost in days, and what was hardest to find?
7. Which model providers are acceptable, and is a tenant-hosted model required for any module?
8. Who signs the criteria, the thresholds and the stop rule?

Appendix A. Why the reference demo is the wrong first tool for a fund

Capability in the demo	What is missing for a fund	Fund OS answer
Deck analysis and company summary	No source pointers; no comparison with the fund's thesis; no record in the CRM	M1-F2, M1-F3, M1-F4

Capability in the demo	What is missing for a fund	Fund OS answer
Research assistant chat about valuation multiples	Numbers from general knowledge, unverifiable; no log	Non-goal; M4 cites data room documents only
Competitive mapping	Unsourced; no evaluation of accuracy	Out of scope for year one; M4 red flags instead
Investment memo generated end to end	Memo written without diligence inputs; no citations	M4 drafts factual sections with citations and marks gaps
Financial model interpretation with chat corrections	Interpretation choices applied silently	M4-F5 highlights choices for a human to accept or reject
Term sheet calculator and generation	A machine producing legal and financial terms	Non-goal; never automated
Funding offer emailed to the founder automatically	An external action with money in it, taken by a machine	Invariant: no message leaves the fund without a person
Founder portal with application status	Useful idea, implemented without a human decision behind it	M1-F6 drafts replies; a person sends them; status reflects a partner's decision

The demo proves that the capabilities are cheap. Fund OS proves that they can be trusted, which is the only thing a fund pays for.

Appendix B. Weekly read-out page (synthetic example for M1, week 3 of the pilot)

Metric	Bar, week 1	Week 2, on the 200	Week 3, live shadow	Status	Next
Recall on "took a meeting"	85 % or more	88 %	86 %	On bar	Two misses to the Friday review
Precision on "meet"	60 % or more	64 %	58 %	Watch	Three cases reviewed with a partner
Minutes per deal, review included	5 or less	4.2	4.6	On bar	Nothing
Automated external actions	0	0	0	On bar	A single one would stop the pilot
Runs failed loudly / silently	any / 0	2 / 0	1 / 0	On bar	Logged, retried, one re-run by hand

Appendix C. Glossary

Gold set: labelled examples owned by the fund used to measure the system. Shadow mode: the system scores live deals while people decide exactly as before. Invariant: a rule checked in code before any action. Read-out: the weekly one-page report of metrics against bar. Definition of done: the verifiable list that closes a module. Burn multiple: net burn divided by net new ARR. NRR: net revenue retention.